LOW-ENERGY PLANNER

The Low-Energy Weekly Reset

A weekly plan that assumes you are a person.

This is not a productivity contest. It is a small weekly appointment for finding the next useful thing and letting the rest wait.

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01 A three-question capacity check-in
02 A one-page reset and weekly map
03 A 20-minute reset ritual
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05 A no-shame restart plan

PLAIN ENGLISH ON PURPOSE

Print it. Write on it.
Make it yours.

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Start with the week you actually have

Most planners ask you to invent a perfect week on Sunday and then punish you for being human by Wednesday. This one starts somewhere else: with the time, energy, and support you actually have.

ADHD can make planning feel like a trap. You make a beautiful list, lose interest in it, forget it exists, then find it three weeks later and feel bad. The problem is usually not effort. It is that the plan was built for a brain and a week that do not exist.

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> **The only rule**
>
> A plan is a guess, not a promise. If the guess is wrong, change the plan. Do not turn the plan into evidence against yourself.

Three questions before any list

01 **What is fixed?** Appointments, shifts, school runs, medication routines, bill due dates, and anything another person is counting on.

02 **What is already heavy?** Sleep, pain, caregiving, a difficult project, a social event, a commute. Name it so the plan can carry it.

03 **What would make this week 5% easier?** Not 100% better. Five percent. One ride, one prepared meal, one postponed decision, one honest no.

The week is not a test

You are allowed to plan for a low-capacity version of yourself. In fact, that is the useful version. If the week goes better than expected, you can add something. If it goes worse, you already have a floor to stand on.

Minimum

The smallest version that keeps the important things from becoming urgent. A bill paid. A prescription requested. A reply sent.

Steady

What you can usually do when nothing is on fire. A little meal planning, a load of laundry, a clear desk.

Stretch

The thing you would love to do if the stars align. Exercise, a project, a social plan. Optional by design.

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Keep the plan where your eyes already go

A planner only works if you encounter it. Put this week's page on the fridge, beside your bed, inside your work bag, or as a photo on your phone's home screen. "Out of sight, out of mind" is not a character flaw; it is a design brief.

What to ignore for now

- Colour-coding every area of life.
- A complicated app you have to maintain.
- A five-year vision board.
- Anyone else's morning routine.
- Catching up on everything the last plan missed.

Where it will live this week

FIRST CHOICE	BACK-UP PLACE	WHEN I WILL LOOK AT IT

The two-second reminder

Something I will see at the right moment — a sticky note, a phone wallpaper, an alarm label:

This page is enough. Turn over when you are ready.

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The one-page reset

Give this ten minutes. If ten is too much, do only the three boxes in the top row. You can leave the rest blank without failing the page.

1. The week in front of me

WHAT IS FIXED?	WHAT IS ALREADY HEAVY?	WHAT WOULD MAKE IT 5% EASIER?

2. Three outcomes, not thirty tasks

An outcome is a finished shape, not a guilt list. “Rent paid” beats “deal with money stuff.” “Clean clothes in drawers” beats “do laundry.”

MY THREE OUTCOMES THIS WEEK	WHAT IS THE SMALLEST FIRST STEP?	WHEN MIGHT IT FIT?
1.		
2.		
3.		

3. The one thing I will ignore on purpose

Permission is a planning tool. Choose something that can wait without serious harm.

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4. Where I need help

Name the kind of help, not just “everything.” “Could you pick up milk?” is easier to answer than “Can you help more?”

WHAT I NEED	WHO COULD HELP?	MY ASK, IN ONE SENTENCE

A menu of asks

Practical

A lift, a meal, a grocery run, watching the kids for an hour, helping move something heavy.

Paperwork

Sitting with me while I make a call, reading a letter together, helping me find the right number.

Company

Being in the room, body doubling on a task, checking in at an agreed time, listening without fixing.

5. Already done

Before you make the week feel impossible, write down one thing that is already handled. You got here. That counts.

TRY THIS

If you only do one thing

Put the three outcomes where you will see them tomorrow. A plan in a notebook you never open is a wish with a cover.

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A 20-minute reset ritual

This is not a full cleaning day. It is a short transition between the week you just finished and the one that is about to start. Use a timer, choose a stopping point, and leave the rest.

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> **Set the timer first**
>
> Twenty minutes means twenty minutes. When it rings, stop even if you are "on a roll." The goal is to make the reset repeatable, not to finish the whole house.

Before the timer

- ☐ One pen and one piece of paper.
- ☐ Your calendar in front of you.
- ☐ A bin bag or recycling bag within reach.
- ☐ The kit: this printable, the one-page reset, and a glass of water.
- ☐ A timer you can hear.

Minute-by-minute

Minutes 0–5 · Empty your head

Write every open loop on scrap paper. Appointments, worry, "I should," half-finished tasks, that thing you keep forgetting. Do not organise yet. Just get it out of the brain and onto the page.

Minutes 5–10 · Match the facts

Check the calendar and your messages. Add only the fixed things. Circle the three outcomes that still matter after seeing the real week.

Minutes 10–15 · Clear one surface

Choose one: kitchen counter, bedside table, entryway, desk. Put trash in the bag. Put items that belong elsewhere in one basket. Do not start a room-by-room overhaul.

Minutes 15–20 · Set the launch pad

Put the reset page where you will see it. Set out one thing for tomorrow. Choose a loose end you are allowed to leave. Then stop.

The stop rule

If the timer ends while you are mid-task, write the next physical action and leave it. "Put the receipts in the blue folder" is a better note than "sort paperwork." A next action is easier to restart than a vague intention.

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Your reset notes

Use this page during or after the reset. It does not need to be tidy. Write the thing you would otherwise keep carrying in your head.

What I noticed

What I want to carry forward

What can wait

What the ritual is not

It is not a test of whether you are “organised enough.” It is a repeated chance to lower the noise. A reset that happens twice a month is still a reset. A reset that happens for five minutes is still a reset.

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Plan around energy, not just time

Two open hours are not the same at 9 a.m. and 9 p.m. Time is on the calendar; capacity is in the body. A plan that ignores energy creates a to-do list that looks reasonable and feels impossible.

Three kinds of tasks

ENERGY	WHAT IT FEELS LIKE	TASKS THAT MIGHT FIT
High	Alert, warm, able to hold several steps	Appointments, paperwork, budgeting, difficult emails, cooking a new meal
Medium	Tired but functional, needs a clear next step	Laundry, dishes, groceries, routine replies, sorting one pile
Low	Foggy, sore, touched out, very little margin	Rest, medication you already take as prescribed, one dish, one email, a snack, asking for help

Your list will be different. The point is to stop assigning high-focus paperwork to your lowest-energy hour.

Use anchors instead of clock times

Clock times can slide past unnoticed. Anchors attach a task to something that already happens.

- After I make coffee, I open the calendar.
- When I plug in my phone, I check tomorrow's appointments.
- Before I sit down to watch something, I put one load of laundry in.
- When I get home, I put my keys in the same place.
- After dinner, I take two minutes for the reset note.

Make time visible

Time blindness is not solved by trying harder. Make the invisible more concrete:

- A visual timer or a kitchen timer.
- A clock within sight of the task.
- A "start at 6:40, stop at 7:00" window written on the page.
- A calendar alarm with a specific action, not just the word "admin."
- Body doubling: another person in the room, on a call, or on a focus timer with you.

> **The two-minute entry**
>
> If starting feels impossible, make the entry step absurdly small: open the document, put on the shoe, pick up one receipt, write the date. You are not committing to the whole task. You are proving it can start.

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A plan with buffers

Leave one blank block in the week. Not because you will definitely need it, but because something usually does. A buffer is not laziness. It is capacity planning.

My energy map

TIME OR ANCHOR	USUAL ENERGY	A REALISTIC TASK	WHAT WOULD MAKE IT EASIER?

Where the buffer goes

DAY OR TIME	WHAT MIGHT TAKE LONGER	THE BUFFER I WILL KEEP

A buffer can be ten minutes, a spare meal, a later start, or a deliberate “no.” It does not have to be a blank hour.

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Your gentle week

This is an undated page. Write the dates in the top row. Choose three priorities for each day — and one anchor that happens whether or not the priorities do.

The three priorities can be tiny. “Shower” is a priority on a hard day. “Send two emails” is a priority. “Rest” can also be a legitimate planned item, not the absence of a plan.

DAY / DATE	THREE PRIORITIES (OR ONE, HONESTLY)	ANCHOR	NOTES

The weekly non-negotiables

- ☐ Food is in the house.
- ☐ Prescriptions and essential appointments are handled.
- ☐ One bill or deadline checked.
- ☐ A little rest is on the calendar, not just “later.”
- ☐ Someone knows where I am if I am away.
- ☐ The plan can survive one bad day.

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My one anchor every day

An anchor is a small routine that tells your brain which part of the day it is. It is not a moral standard. Examples: morning medication with breakfast, ten minutes outside, a five-minute tidy-up, a message to one person, lights out at the same time.

What I will do when the day goes sideways

Write it now, while you are calm. A pre-decided response is easier than inventing one from the middle of a hard moment. Examples: drop the lowest priority, send “I need to move this,” order the easiest safe food, ask someone to sit with me, go to bed without “catching up.”

My back-up anchor

When the usual anchor is impossible, the back-up is:

Anchor check

- ☐ It takes under two minutes.
- ☐ It attaches to something that already happens.
- ☐ It is kind on a bad day.
- ☐ I will notice when it is missing.

> TRY THIS
>
> **Leave some white space**
>
> A page with air in it is easier to return to. You do not need to fill every square to have a valid week.

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The daily minimum

Some days are survival days. Some are steady. A few are good. Instead of one impossible standard, choose the version that matches the day, then stop moving the goalposts.

Survival day

The bar is care, not achievement.

- ☐ I took prescribed medication as directed, if I have one.
- ☐ I ate or drank something.
- ☐ I handled the smallest urgent thing.
- ☐ I told someone if I needed help.

My one kind thing today:

Steady day

A little forward motion, plus the basics.

- ☐ The survival basics.
- ☐ One 10-minute task from the list.
- ☐ One message or appointment handled.
- ☐ One reset gesture (dishes, trash, surface, laundry).

My 10-minute task:

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Good day

Use the energy without spending all of it.

- ☐ The steady basics.
- ☐ One meaningful outcome.
- ☐ One thing that makes tomorrow easier.
- ☐ A deliberate stop time.

My meaningful outcome:

WATCH OUT

Do not use a good day to “pay back” a bad one

A burst of energy is not a debt settlement. If you spend every good day trying to repay the past, you will arrive at tomorrow with nothing left. Use some of the good day for the future, and keep some for now.

The after-check

At the end of the day, ask two questions. Not “Did I do enough?” That question has no useful answer. Instead:

01 What actually happened?

02 What would make the next hour slightly easier?

Answer in one line each, if that is all the energy you have.

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When the week falls apart

It will sometimes. A flare, a sick child, a work crisis, a depression dip, a lost phone, a plan that was too optimistic. A broken week is not a broken system, and it is not a reason to abandon the whole page.

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> **The reset does not require a fresh start**
>
> You do not need a new planner, a new month, or a dramatic Monday. You need the next small action. Keep the page with its crossings-out. It is a record, not a failure.

Triage the backlog

Sort every missed item into one of four moves:

MOVE	ASK	EXAMPLE
Drop	Does this actually matter now?	A non-essential organising project
Delay	Is there a real later date?	A routine appointment that can be rebooked
Delegate	Can someone else do it, or help?	Groceries, a ride, a two-person task
Shrink	What is the five-minute version?	One bill instead of the whole pile

If an item does not fit one of those moves, it is probably not a task. It may be a worry. Put it in a “think about later” box instead of letting it colonise the list.

The five-minute restart

- ☐ Set a timer for five minutes.
- ☐ Choose one item from the shrink column.
- ☐ Remove one obstacle: open the tab, find the phone number, get the envelope, move the laundry basket.
- ☐ Do only the first step.
- ☐ Stop when the timer ends, even if you feel like continuing.

Ask for help without a speech

Choose the sentence that fits. Change it so it sounds like you.

- “I’m having a low-capacity day. Could you take over [specific task]?”
- “I missed [thing]. Can we move it to [day/time]?”
- “I don’t need you to fix it. Could you sit with me while I make the call?”
- “I’m overwhelmed. Can you help me choose the first step?”
- “I need a 24-hour extension. Is that possible?”

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My restart note

What happened (facts only):

The next smallest action:

What I am allowed to drop:

Who I can tell

When I will check in

DATE	TIME	THE ONE QUESTION I WILL ASK

What I will try differently

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Your reset menu

A reset does not have to be twenty minutes. It can be shorter, and it still counts. Choose the version that fits the moment.

5 minutes

Pick one surface. Put away five things. Write tomorrow's first action on a sticky note. Stop.

15 minutes

Do the three-question check-in. Choose one outcome. Put one load of laundry in or clear one surface. Set one alarm.

45 minutes

Do the full reset ritual, plan the week's three outcomes, and make one thing easier for the next day — groceries ordered, clothes laid out, a message sent.

The keep-it-going checklist

- ☐ The reset page is where I will see it.
- ☐ Tomorrow has one starting point.
- ☐ There is at least one buffer in the week.
- ☐ I have a plan for the lowest-energy day.
- ☐ I know one person I can ask for help.
- ☐ Something has been deliberately left undone.

Three questions at the end of the week

Keep this short. A long review becomes another task to avoid.

01 **What worked?** Even if it was just "I opened the planner twice."

02 **What got in the way?** Name the obstacle, not your character.

03 **What should be smaller, different, or dropped next week?**

My three answers

TRY THIS

The goal is not a perfect routine

The goal is a routine that can be found again after it disappears. Leave a trail back to the page. Put it where you will bump into it, keep the pen nearby, and make the next version easier than the last.

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A week can be mostly Okay

Some weeks have a clean kitchen and three appointments and a lovely plan. Some weeks have clean socks and a phone call. Both are weeks you got through. The planner is not the judge; it is a landing pad.

The one-page takeaway

- Plan for the energy you have, not the energy you wish you had.
- Choose outcomes, then shrink the first step until it starts.
- Make the plan visible and the entry cheap.
- When the week breaks, triage before you moralise.
- Keep the version that helps; drop the ritual that becomes a chore.

My next small step

GOOD TO KNOW

A final permission slip

You do not have to become a different person to be helped by a piece of paper. You just need one place to put the next thing.

ONE LAST THING · 07

Use one thing. Then keep it.

Set a 20-minute appointment with yourself this week. Bring a pen, a calendar, and the truth about your energy — not the version of your week you wish you were having.

MY NEXT SMALL STEP

THE RULE FOR THIS HALF OF THE PACK

A system should fit your real energy, not the other way around. Keep what helps, drop what becomes another chore, and let the next small step be enough.

More life-admin printables

- 08 The Paper Pile Triage Kit
- 09 Bills, Renewals & Subscriptions
- 10 The Appointment Companion
- 11 The Low-Energy Meal Plan
- 12 The Household Command Center

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Keep the useful part. Leave the rest.